

EAP-MD5

Extensible Authentication Protocol-Message Digest 5. EAP-MD5 is an EAP security algorithm developed by Rivest-Shamir-Adleman (RSA) Security that uses a 128-bit generated number string, or hash, to verify the authenticity of a data communication.

EAP-TLS

Extensible Authentication Protocol-Transport Layer Security. This high-security version of EAP requires authentication from both the client and the server. If one of them fails to offer the appropriate authenticator, the connection is terminated.

Encryption

The process of changing data into a form that can be read only by the intended receiver. To decipher the message, the receiver of the encrypted data must have the proper decryption key. In traditional encryption schemes, the sender and the receiver use the same key to encrypt and decrypt data. Public-key encryption schemes use two keys: a public key, which anyone may use, and a corresponding private key, which is possessed only by the person who created it. With this method, anyone may send a message encrypted with the owner's public key, but only the owner has the private key necessary to decrypt it. PGP (Pretty Good Privacy) and DES (data encryption standard) are two of the most popular public-key encryption schemes.

ESS

Extended Service Set. This is the collective term for two or more Basic Service Sets (*see* BSS) that use the same switch in a LAN.

ESSID

Extended Service Set Identifier. An ESSID is the unique identifier for an ESS. Also *see* SSID.

Ethernet

A standard for connecting computers in a local-area network (LAN). Ethernet is also called 10BaseT, which denotes a peak transmission speed of 10Mbps using copper twisted-pair cable.